D.J. PARIS

$1.99 TRILLION. SMALLER THAN THIS YEAR.

The mortgage industry's own forecast for 2027.

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THE GROUP THAT FORECASTS MORTGAGES SAYS 2027 IS SMALLER THAN 2026, NOT BIGGER.

And rates stay above 7 percent the whole year, by their own number.

IT ISN'T SHRINKING EVENLY. REFINANCES ARE THE ONES COLLAPSING.

The Mortgage Bankers Association's own October 2026 forecast puts total 2027 mortgage volume at 1.99 trillion dollars, down 5 percent from 2026's 2.1 trillion. But purchase loans actually rise slightly, up to 1.42 trillion. Refinances fall 17 percent, down to 571 billion. The part of the market getting smaller is refinance business. The part agents actually work, home purchases, is not.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR BUSINESS PLAN:

1 **Stop waiting on a refi-driven rebound.**
MBA's own forecast has refinances dropping another

2 **17 percent next year. That demand is not coming back soon.**

3 **Plan around purchase volume, not total volume.**
The headline number is shrinking because of

4 **refinances. Purchase volume is projected to grow slightly in the same forecast.**

5 **Tell buyers 7 percent is the planning number for 2027, not a peak to wait out.**
The same

6 **forecast has rates staying above 7 percent through next year.**

7 **Ask your lender how much of their business is purchase versus refi.**
A lender built around

8 **refinance volume has less reason to fight hard for your buyer's file next year.**

THE TAKEAWAY

PULL UP YOUR PIPELINE RIGHT NOW AND COUNT HOW MANY DEALS ASSUME RATES DROP NEXT YEAR.

The group that forecasts mortgages says don't plan on it.

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